

CHAINLAB

Blockchain Research and Due Diligence

How to evaluate projects, claims and on-chain evidence

FREE BLOCKCHAIN EDUCATION RESOURCE

This guide is designed for learning and revision. It explains foundational concepts and highlights practical limitations and safety considerations.

Learning objectives

- Separate verifiable facts from promotional claims.
- Use a structured research checklist.
- Recognize limitations in public metrics and dashboards.

1. Start with primary evidence

- Read project documentation, source repositories, governance proposals, audits and official announcements. Confirm that the source belongs to the project and is current.
- For on-chain claims, inspect relevant transactions, account states, authorities and contract/program addresses using reputable explorers or independent tooling.

2. Verify the identity

- Compare addresses across official documentation and multiple reliable sources. Beware of search ads, cloned websites, lookalike characters and impersonated social accounts.
- Check whether a repository is active, whether releases correspond to deployed code and whether the deployment is verifiably linked to the published source.

3. Evaluate claims

- Translate vague claims such as 'fully decentralized' or 'audited' into testable questions: who controls upgrades, what was audited, what version was reviewed, and what dependencies remain?
- Record dates, definitions and methodology for metrics such as users, volume, TVL, circulating supply and validator count. Different providers may calculate them differently.

4. Read audits responsibly

- Check the audit date, scope, commit or version reviewed, severity definitions, unresolved findings and whether fixes were retested.
- An audit is a point-in-time review of a defined scope. It may not cover economic design, deployment configuration, frontend security or later changes.

5. Research worksheet

- Project and network: _____
- Official documentation and verified addresses: _____
- Key administrators and upgrade controls: _____
- Token distribution and vesting: _____
- Security reviews and unresolved findings: _____
- Liquidity and market structure: _____
- Known dependencies and risks: _____

■ Evidence gaps and questions: _____

Review questions

- Why should metrics include dates and definitions?
- What does an audit scope tell you?
- Name four sources of evidence for project research.

Educational notice: This material is for general education only. It is not financial, legal, tax or investment advice. Verify current network and project details before acting.